Arushi · winter semester · Oct 26 – Jan 3

how I'm building my own *personal curriculum*

10 weeks · about 3.5 hours a week · learning for its own sake. One core course at a time, four courses running all semester, and a capstone to prove it.

1. Start here

Where am I now? Strengths, habits, what's draining me

Who do I want to be by Jan 3?

My word for this semester:

2. Course catalogue

FIN 101 · WKS 1–2
Money & Investing

PRD 101 · WKS 3–4
Product Thinking

AI 101 · WKS 5–7
How AI Actually Works

HIS 101 · WKS 8–9
Geopolitics & History

CUR 100 · ALL SEMESTER
Current Affairs

SPK 100 · ALL SEMESTER
Speaking with Structure

CRE 100 · ALL SEMESTER
Creative Lab

LIT 100 · DAILY
Reading for Pleasure

Move Every Day — FIT 100 · DAILY · EMERGENCY / MEDIUM / REGULAR

3. My week

Mon–Thu 10:45	Core course reading or video	**4 × 20m**
Sat 11:00	Core course lab (hands-on)	**45m**
Sat 12:00	Speaking: record a 2-min video	**15m**
Sun 11:00	Current affairs: India + world	**30m**
Sun 16:00	Creative lab: make something	**45m**
Daily 20:30	Move: pick Emergency, Medium or Regular	**10k goal**
Daily 14:00	Fun reading, 20 pages (+ Murdle at night)	**bonus**

4. The semester



pass = the deliverable exists

miss a day, fine. never two in a row

all notes in one notebook

FIN 101 · WEEKS 1–2 · OCT 26 – NOV 8

money & investing

goal: get how markets and index funds work, then write my own money rules

Week 1

Read · The Psychology of Money, ch. 1–10

Study · Zerodha Varsity, Module 1, ch. 1–5

Lab · Compare 2 Nifty 50 index funds on Value Research: expense ratio, tracking error, fund size

Week 2

Read · The Psychology of Money, ch. 11–20

Watch · CA Rachana Ranade: SIP vs lump sum

Lab · Map your money in 4 buckets: needs, wants, invest, buffer

BOOK
The Psychology of Money, Morgan Housel

EXTRA BOOK
Let's Talk Money, Monika Halan

WEBSITES
Zerodha Varsity · Value Research Online

YOUTUBE
CA Rachana Ranade

Capstone · one page: your fund comparison + your 3-line investing rules

PRD 101 · WEEKS 3–4 · NOV 9 – NOV 22

product thinking

goal: find the real user problem before talking about features

Week 3

Read · The Mom Test, ch. 1–4

Read · Good Product Manager / Bad Product Manager, Ben Horowitz

Lab · Interview 2 friends about an app they use daily, Mom Test style

Week 4

Read · The Mom Test, ch. 5–8

Listen · One Lenny's Podcast episode on product sense

Lab · Teardown: user, problem, what works, one change you'd make

BOOK
The Mom Test, Rob Fitzpatrick

ARTICLE
Good PM / Bad PM, Ben Horowitz

PODCAST + NEWSLETTER
Lenny's Podcast · Lenny's Newsletter

YOUTUBE
Exponent (product sense)

Capstone · a one-page app teardown backed by 2 real interviews

AI 101 · WEEKS 5–7 · NOV 23 – DEC 13

how AI actually works

goal: explain an LLM in plain words, and know where AI helps or fails

Week 5

Watch · 3Blue1Brown neural networks, ch. 1–2

Read · Co-Intelligence, Part I

Lab · Use one AI tool on a real task. Log what worked and what failed

Week 6

Watch · Andrej Karpathy, Intro to Large Language Models (in 2 sittings)

Watch · 3Blue1Brown, But what is a GPT?

Lab · Tool log #2: the same prompt on two different AI models

Week 7

Read · Co-Intelligence, Part II

Read · 2 posts from One Useful Thing

Lab · Tool log #3 + script your explainer video

BOOK
Co-Intelligence, Ethan Mollick

YOUTUBE
3Blue1Brown · Andrej Karpathy

NEWSLETTER
One Useful Thing, Ethan Mollick

FREE COURSE
Elements of AI (optional, deeper)

Capstone · a 2-minute video, "how an LLM works," + your 3-week tool log

HIS 101 · WEEKS 8–9 · DEC 14 – DEC 27

geopolitics & history

goal: see how geography and the past shape today's headlines, India and world

Week 8

Read · Prisoners of Geography: China, then India and Pakistan

Watch · 2 episodes of ThePrint's Cut the Clutter

Lab · Pick one current India story. List the 5 past events behind it

Week 9

Read · Prisoners of Geography: USA, then Russia

Watch · 2 Caspian Report videos on a current world story

Lab · Same exercise for one world story

BOOK
Prisoners of Geography, Tim Marshall

PODCAST
The Rest Is History (just for fun)

YOUTUBE
Cut the Clutter · Caspian Report

WEBSITE
Our World in Data

Capstone · two one-page timelines: one India story, one world story

FINALS WEEK · DEC 28 – JAN 3

the big capstone

Record a 5-minute talk: **"4 things I learned this semester,"** one per core course. Reread your notebook first. Then fill in your December digest and pick next semester's courses.

running every week, oct 26 – jan 3

all-semester courses

CUR 100 · SUN 30 MIN

Current Affairs

Each Sunday, 3 stories: one India, one world, one business. Write one line on each, plus one question you're still curious about.

India · Indian Express "Explained"

World · Reuters World

Business · Mint

Video · Cut the Clutter (weekly pick)

SPK 100 · SAT 15 MIN

Speaking with Structure

Every Saturday, record a 2-min video explaining one idea from the week using **PREP**: Point, Reason, Example, Point.

Wk 3 · rewatch, fix one habit

Wk 6 · record with no notes

Watch · Julian Treasure TED talk on speaking

YouTube · Vinh Giang

Creative Lab

CRE 100 · SUN 45 MIN

Wk 1 · cook a dish you've never made

Wk 2 · photo walk: 10 shots, one colour

Wk 3 · Murdle night with friends

Wk 4 · make a bookmark or zine page

Wk 5 · bake something new

Wk 6 · photo walk at Sunder Nursery

Wk 7 · sudoku race + journal collage

Wk 8 · handmade holiday cards

Wk 9 · Christmas bake

Wk 10 · scrapbook your digest page

nightly: Murdle Volume 1 (G.T. Karber) or one sudoku, 10 min

Reading for Pleasure

LIT 100 · 20 PAGES AT 2 PM

Not homework. Two warm, easy page-turners to pull you out of a reading slump.

WEEKS 1–5 · FUNNY & HEARTFELT

Eleanor Oliphant Is Completely Fine

Gail Honeyman

A blunt, routine-bound Glasgow office worker slowly lets people in. Laugh-out-loud funny, then quietly moving, with the Anxious People feel.

WEEKS 6–10 · COSY & QUIRKY

Remarkably Bright Creatures

Shelby Van Pelt

A widow on the night shift at an aquarium befriends a grumpy, very clever octopus. Short chapters and impossible to put down.

FIT 100 · EVERY DAY · ALL SEMESTER

move every day

pick a tier each morning. zero is not an option

TIER E · ~10 MIN

Emergency

no time at all

3,000 steps
or a 10-min walk + 20 squats + 1-min plank

TIER M · ~30 MIN

Medium

busy day

6,000 steps
or a 20-min home workout

TIER R · THE STANDARD

Regular

most days

10,000 steps
+ 5 min of stretching

Weekly rules

4+	Regular days, minimum
≤2	Medium days, maximum
≤1	Emergency day, maximum
0	Zero days. Emergency is the floor, and never two in a row

Finding 10k on a workday: 2k walk before work, take calls on foot, a 15-min loop after lunch, and your 8:30 pm walk. Save a long walk for the weekend.

Tracker

write E, M or R in each circle

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	R's
Wk 1	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 2	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 3	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 4	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 5	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 6	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 7	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 8	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 9	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____
Wk 10	○	○	○	○	○	○	○	_____

the _____ digest

fill one in on the last Sunday of November and December

read

_____ %

_____ %

_____ %

learned

FIN

PRD

AI

HIS

watched + listened

made

tape a photo here

said

my speaking videos this month

in's

out's

proudest moment

next month I'll...